M4 Aspirin

Scope of Practice	EMR
Classification	• Platelet aggregator inhibitor
Usual Presentation	• 81mg/tablet
Mechanism of Action	• Aspirin (acetylsalicylic acid) provides antiplatelet, fever-reducing, and pain-relieving effects. • In DCAS, aspirin is used solely for its antiplatelet properties. • Aspirin blocks the cyclooxygenase enzyme, which leads to a decrease in the production of prostaglandin and thromboxane.
Indications	• Acute Coronary Syndrome
Contraindications	• Known allergy • Pregnancy • Active peptic ulcer disease
Precautions	• Asthma/COPD (previous history of worsening bronchospasm after NSAID administration. • Clinically significant active bleeding (e.g. GI bleeding) – aspiring will increase bleeding.
Side Effects	• Increased bleeding
Adult Dose & Administration	• 324mg (4 tablets). • Tablets should be chewed before swallowing
Pediatric Dose & Administration	• Not to be administered to pediatrics
Use in Pregnancy and Lactation	• Pregnancy: as has demonstrated fetal harm in the third trimester. • The likelihood of myocardial infarction or ischemia in pregnancy is very low, aspirin should generally be withheld. • Lactation: May be administered during pregnancy, the mother should be advised to stop breast feeding until advised by their physician.

Additional Information	• If the patient has taken aspirin within the last 60 minutes:
	  • Confirm the dose they have received.
	  • Administer additional Aspirin to reach a maximum total dose of 324mg.